

8.2 Bootstrapping vs. External Funding: The Startup Dilemma



Starting a business is exciting, but one question looms over every founder's head.

Where will the Money Come from?

Do You Dig into your Savings and Grow Steadily?

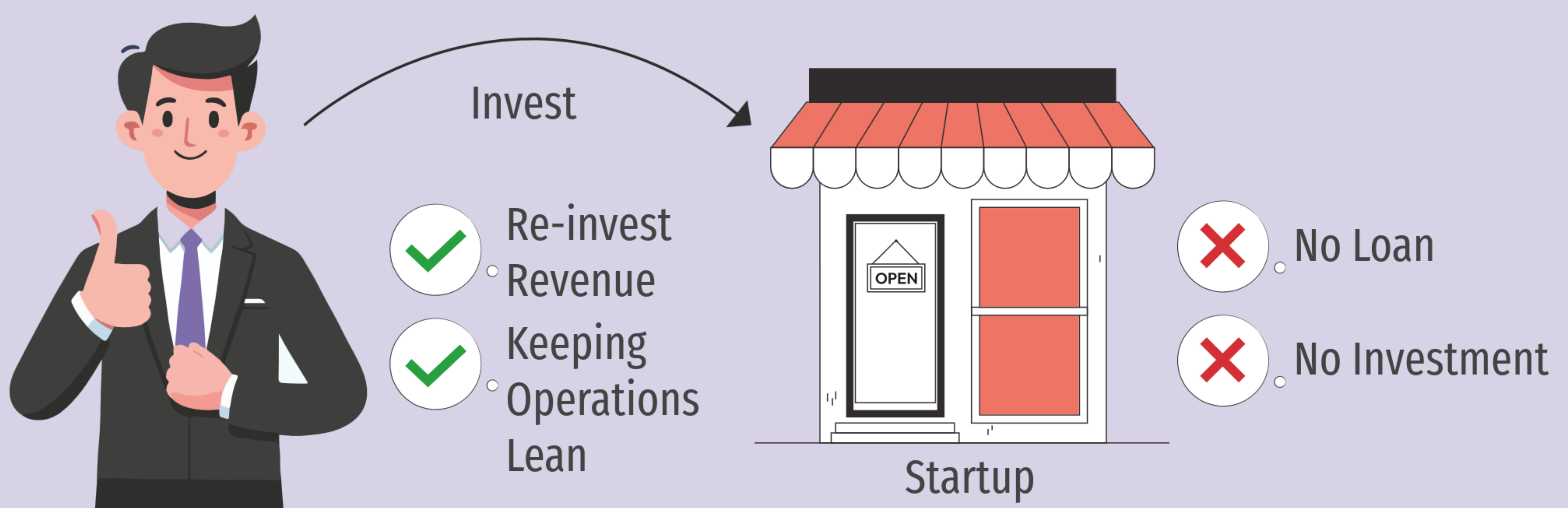
Do You Raise Capital and Go Full Throttle from Day One?

There's no one-size-fits-all answer. It depends on the kind of business you're building, how fast you want to scale, and how much control you're willing to give up.

Let's break it down.

1. Bootstrapping: Betting on Yourself

Bootstrapping is the art of self-funding your startup. It involves using personal savings, reinvesting revenue, and keeping operations lean. There are no investors or loans; it involves just you, your vision, and your ability to make every rupee count.



Some of the biggest companies today—Mailchimp, Zoho, and even the early days of Apple—started this way. It's not easy, but if done right, it gives you the kind of freedom that external funding never will.